Knowledge organiser (SUMMIT) — Framing a site-specific visual brief

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 1 Part 2 · Big question: How do architects and public artists analyse spatial context, sightlines, and structural form to write a rigorous studio brief?

Core studio focus

Family: Studio suite

Big question: How do architects and public artists analyse spatial context, sightlines, and structural form to write a rigorous studio brief?

• Analyse a site reference pack for architectural geometry, material texture, and audience viewpoint.

• Produce observational structural studies isolating primary load-bearing spans and negative-space voids.

• Draft a formal site-specific studio brief defining intent, material constraints, scale, and visual impact.

Essential vocabulary

• site-specific: Designed deliberately to respond to the architecture, materials, and viewpoints of a particular place.

• sightline: The direct line of view from an audience position to the artwork.

• void: A deliberate open negative space carved through or framed by a solid structure.

• constraint: A practical boundary (scale, material palette, or relief depth) that focuses a design.

• elevation: A flat, proportional side-on drawing of a structure.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Extract structural vectors and voids: I lay an acetate grid over the site card and sketch the primary cantilever span and triangular negative-space voids.

Step 2: Define macro silhouette and micro patina: I specify a three-level greyboard/foil relief profile with high-contrast slate and oxide patina.

Step 3: Write and annotate the formal Studio brief: I complete the four-part Studio brief sections (Intent, Geometry, Material spec, and Sightline check) around my elevation drawing.